

VARC – 1

Direction for question 1: In the following question, there are five sentences. The sentence labelled a is in its correct place. The four that follow are labelled b, c, d and e, and need to be arranged in the logical order to form a coherent paragraph. From the given options, choose the most appropriate option:

- a. The International Solar Alliance (ISA) was jointly announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and French President François Hollande on November 30, 2015 at the UN Paris Climate Change Conference.
- b. Prospective member countries want to know when to sign up.
- c. Since then the International Steering Committee has met thrice; an Interim Administrative cell meets regularly; and an ISA ministerial-level meeting was held at the UN Headquarters in April 2016.
- d. Despite the ball moving behind the scenes, public understanding about ISA's role, scope and future direction remains limited.
- e. Two multi-country work programmes have been launched; India has committed financial support worth Rs. 400 crore; the foundation stone for the ISA headquarters in Gurugram; and joined declarations were signed with the UN Development programme and the World Bank.

☐ a) bcde

☐ b) cbcd

☒ c) ecdb (Your answer - ✖)

☐ d) cedb (Correct Answer - ✔)

Q2



Directions for questions 2 and 3: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Years of mismanagement of Venezuela's oil-rich economy, first by Hugo Chavez and latterly by Nicolas Maduro, his successor, have come home to roost.
2. Much of its oil revenue has been sucked up by corruption, or diverted to unsustainable social programmes and subsidies to allies, especially Cuba.
3. The country is sitting on the world's largest oil reserves, but scaring off the investment needed to exploit them; the private sector is treated like a hostile force.
4. Throw in rampant crime, and no wonder the country is buckling under the biggest protests in a decade.
5. Basic goods, from cooking oil to toilet paper, are scarce.

Your Answer: Unattempted

Correct Answer: 13254 ✔

Directions for questions 2 and 3: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. The pace of such change is unprecedented; the absence of a backlash would be a surprise.
2. Most Americans back gay marriage, but most also say it violates their religious beliefs.
3. Social conservatism remains a potent political force as the gay-marriage juggernaut rolls on.
4. 'And so they have retreated to the realm of faith, where there is no obligation to provide argument, merely to demonstrate sincerity of belief.
5. The difficulty for conservatives is that their rational contentions – that gay unions are bad for children, or the institution of marriage – have, one by one, been weighed in courts and rejected.

Your Answer: Unattempted

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Solution:

(5) cannot begin the paragraph as social conservatism is introduced in (3). (2) cannot begin the paragraph as (3) puts the topic sentence of the paragraph into perspective. Social conservatism in gay-marriage. (3) which is the opening sentence, is substantiated by (2). (5) demonstrates the backlash mentioned in (1). (4) describes the outcome of (5) as a last option for conservatives.
Ans : (32154)

Q4



Directions for questions 4 to 6: Each of the following questions presents 4 statements of which 3, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. The fat from buffalo's milk has a higher melting point than that from cow's milk due to its higher proportion of saturated fatty acids.
2. Buffalo's milk contains less cholesterol when compared with cow's milk.
3. The composition of buffalo's milk differs very much from cow's milk with respect to all nutrients.
4. The biggest difference relates to fat : certain buffalo breeds may contain up to 13 per cent fat.

Your Answer: 3 ✖

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Solution:

These four statements indicate a study between buffalo's and cow's milk. (3) which talks about the difference in the composition between buffalo's milk and cow's milk, seems to be the opening statement. 4 follows 3 by specifically talking about the difference in the fat content. 1 is a continuation of 4. (2) particularly talks about cholesterol content in buffalo's milk, which is lesser in cow's milk, hence it is the odd man out. The order is, thus, 341
Ans : (2)

Q5



Directions for questions 4 to 6: Each of the following questions presents 4 statements of which 3, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. The use of photography is widely seen as an important part of a murder investigation.
2. Technology is an important part of this field as without it, forensic scientists wouldn't have the ability to complete many core analysis including the ability to produce a DNA profile or scan and store fingerprints electronically.
3. Forensic science is the use of science to assist the police in the investigation of a crime.
4. Digital forensic experts are now using the latest computing technologies to detect and identify suspects in cyber crime cases.

Your Answer: 1

Q6



Directions for questions 4 to 6: Each of the following questions presents 4 statements of which 3, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. One aspect that the reams of paper and hours of discussion around the GST regime seem to have ignored is the area of Intellectual property.
2. The whole country was delighted to receive the news of the Goods and Service Tax (GST) Bill getting passed in the Rajya Sabha recently.
3. GST should help foster the minuscule IP ecosystem in the country.
4. The National Intellectual Property Right Policy (NIPRP) was released in May 2016 by the Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion.

Your Answer: Unattempted

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Solution:

The first three statements, (1), (2) and (3) focuses upon GST and mention IP as a missing aspect in the GST regime. (4) is solely about NIPRP. The first three statements, if arranged as (2), (1), (3) form a coherent paragraph. (4) is not the part of this context.
Ans : (4)

Direction for questions 7 to 9: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below, each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

Not only have Americans been guzzling ____ fizzy drinks in recent years, but Pepsi's share of those falling sales has ____.

- ☐ a) more . . . gained
- ☐ b) larger . . . dropped
- ☐ c) smaller . . . increased

☒ d) fewer . . . slipped (Your answer - ✓)

Direction for questions 7 to 9: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below, each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

She observed a strange gentleness, almost ____, about the big male monkey, but as a primatologist, she could tell he was ____ by the way the subordinates feared him.

☐ a) indifference . . . violent

☒ b) courteousness . . . dominant (Your answer - ✓)

☐ c) meekness . . . dangerous

☐ d) aggression . . . passive

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Solution:

The first blank is simply an extension of gentleness, which is courteousness.
The second blank is simply antonymous to subordinates, which is dominant.
Choice (B)

Direction for questions 7 to 9: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below, each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

They had to apologize for her ____ to the people in the shops, and received ____ smiles.

- ☐ a) rudeness . . . commiserating
- ☐ b) caricature . . . mollifying
- ☐ c) retardation . . . sarcastic
- ☐ d) stupidity . . . malevolent

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Solution:

The sentence in question occurs in a civilized context, given that apologies were tendered, so sarcastic and malevolent are ruled out. caricature does not make sense in the shopping context, so the choice is narrowed down to (A) apologize – rudeness – commiserate(console).
Choice (A)

Q10



Direction for question 10: In the following question a paragraph with a blank is given. From the four choices, select the sentence, which can go into the blank to make the paragraph logically coherent.

Cash is no longer the king – at least when it comes to paying for consumer goods, _____. Retailers and banks attribute this to the government's clampdown on black money. The regulators are also putting sustained efforts to push digital and electronic payment systems.

- ☐ a) Promotions through cards and loans are seen as an attractive option and this is easier to track sales at cash carry outlets.
- ☐ b) There is easy availability of credit among other factors.
- ☐ c) Panasonic India CEO Manish Sharma pointed to another trend - more than half of all the buyers are in the 18-24 year age bracket.

☒ d) Cards and consumer finance are becoming the dominant modes for settling bills in urban India. (Your answer - ✓)

Direction for question 11: In the following question, a part of the sentence is underlined and is followed by four different ways of phrasing the underlined part. Choose the correct part.

Laloo Prasad Yadav uses euphemistic tactics to win the elections but has the churlishness to face the press.

- ☐ a) machiavellian tactics to win the elections but has the churlishness
- ☐ b) euphemistic tactics to win the elections but has the churlishness
- ☐ c) machiavellian tactics to win the elections but has the chutzpah
- ☐ d) euphemistic tactics to win the elections but has the chutzpah

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Solution:

Two pairs of words – euphemistic (mild expression substituted for a blunt one), machiavellian (cunning), and churlishness (meanness), chutzpah (shameless audacity) are used in the sentence. Laloo Prasad uses Machiavellian tactics on one side but is shamelessly bold on the other side.
Choice (C)

Direction for questions 12: In the following question, a word with its contextual usage is provided. Pick the word from among the alternatives that is the most appropriate substitute for the question word in the given context and mark the letter corresponding with it as your answer.

LITTER: English life seems to be littered with the burnt-out relics of young men and women who were once hailed as 'promising' or acclaimed as 'geniuses'.

- ☐ a) strewn
- ☐ b) purged
- ☐ c) scoured
- ☐ d) frayed

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Solution:

To 'litter' is to scatter untidily. The appropriate word is 'strewn'.
Choice (A)

Direction for question 13: The following question consists of an idiom which is underlined. From among the given options, choose the one which correctly expresses the meaning of the underlined idiom.

John was born with a silver spoon in his mouth and was spoiled to the hilt by his indulgent parents.

☐ a) born with a physical deformity

☒ b) born in wealth and luxury (Your answer - ✓)

☐ c) was the only child of his parents

☐ d) was a sickly child right from birth

Direction for question 14: An idiom and four possible meanings are given. Identify the meaning from the choices and mark its corresponding letter as your answer.

To get the better of someone

☒ a) To gain an advantage over someone (Your answer - ✓)

☐ b) To pander to someone's demands

☐ c) To lend a helping hand to someone

☐ d) To offer good advice to someone

Direction for question 15: In the following question, the word at the top is used in four different ways, A to D. Choose the option in which the usage of the word is INCORRECT or INAPPROPRIATE.

MUDDLE

- ☐ a) We must have a definite plan; we cannot just keep muddling like this.
- ☐ b) The entire flasco was the result of a bureaucratic muddle.
- ☐ c) I am sorry that things are in such a muddle.

☒ d) He seems to have got all muddled up with the dates. (Your answer - ✖)

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Solution:

Sentence A is wrong because it should be 'muddling along' which means to continue doing something without a clear plan or purpose.
Choice (A)